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LINKEDIN PROFILE MAKING

“Being solicited on LinkedIn is a real thing that happens.”

Whitney Wolfe Herd

“LinkedIn is increasingly becoming a very strong place for companies to develop their talent plans, their recruitment plans, and so there are ways in which we can track some of the momentum there.”

Jeff Weiner

LinkedIn is an online networking platform for professionals. It is the ‘facebook’ for business owners, head honchos of companies, and employees. The portal provides numerous opportunities through a free account to search for internships and jobs. The presence for a newcomer, an experienced professional, or an established business can be understood better under the following aspects of participating on LinkedIn.

Visibility: this involves creating a space for yourself in the relevant or sought domain within the sphere of work. Visibility begins with adding a photograph to your profile, as it is first thing that others will notice about you. It is best to include a professional looking photograph but not a photograph clicked for a passport. The picture should present to the networkers your image as a professional. Therefore, you at work in your office against a professional or a neutral background in a professional attire is good. It is always better to look into the camera while getting the picture clicked; it conveys your clear intent to engage with the other networkers through your profile picture itself. It is not advisable to put up a picture when you are attending a conference or an event as that is not a regular day at work. Also, many college or university students like to put up a picture where they are dressed for an occasion like a celebration in the family or the farewell party in their school or university. Such pictures are also not appropriate for a LinkedIn profile.

About information is the next step in creating visibility. It is advisable to put your primary occupation or target job profile as the first item in this section. Ensure that you include many generic terms and top skills in this

description so that you may show up on searches. Your minor and other professional competencies and pursuits may find a mention in the subsequent parts of the text. It is advisable to break up the text into different paragraphs as different aspects find a mention. You can even provide an outline in reverse chronological order as you develop your about information.

Experience section of your profile contains details of your work history. This portion of the text should appear in the reverse chronological order. It should provide details in months and years of remaining in that particular job. It is advisable to link organisations if they have an account/presence on LinkedIn. This enhances the possibility of you appearing on searches related to these outfits.

Education history provides an insight into your claim to possess the skills and competencies. It should again be in reverse chronological order. Include the exact degrees or certifications while filling in the data in this section. Again, if possible include the link to your school, college or university, if they have an account on LinkedIn.

The above three parts take immediate care of your visibility on LinkedIn. You can work on creating greater visibility by posting regular articles/posts on your profile related to your skills, area of work or area of interest for new work opportunities.

LinkedIn provides a helpful feature of including hash-tags in the posts. These should always be used. Create a word document of your most-commonly used tags on a specific topic for use at all times. You can copy and paste from this document. You can also save links to your website, blogging handle, YouTube channel, Instagram profile, and other social media presence in this document. This will save a lot of time and lend uniformity to your posts and shares.

Credibility: you can create greater credibility for your skills and competencies by seeking endorsements from your connections and contacts on LinkedIn. People who have worked with you in the past, such as, colleagues, bosses, and clients should be able to endorse you for skill(s) from a pre-published list on the portal. Some people can even be encouraged to write a short testimonial for you regarding your service, product or skill. This is then published in your profile. It is advisable to seek testimonials and endorsements from other profile owners immediately after you have concluded an assignment or project for them. In some cases you can draft a few sentences for a client/connection, get it approved from them and request them to post it as a testimonial for you.

Networking: the basic purpose of a LinkedIn profile is to network with professionals for work or collaboration opportunities. One can search for people, jobs, companies, groups, content, and schools on LinkedIn. While you can follow content and schools on the portal to remain updated about the latest happenings from these entities,

you can search for people to form connections with them. It is also possible for you to search for jobs and internships through the search tab.

Joining groups on LinkedIn helps you to get into concentrated professional networks. These then become a marketplace of your skills and experience which may lead to a professional association.

Searching for companies on LinkedIn helps to ascertain the presence of organisations that may require the skills and competencies that you possess. A popular and acceptable course of action for cold-calling can be developed through this feature of LinkedIn.

The 'work' tab on LinkedIn with multiple features, such as training, solutions, insights and posting a job, are valuable and relevant for a company or an organisation.

The other way to network on the portal is through the content posted by others. You can post a comment on someone else's post. Ensure to keep the comment relevant and in good taste. The comment should be made with the sole purpose of pitching yourself and your skills. A comment which enhances value for other readers of the post and also the creator of the post gets more attention. One can include links to another article or content on LinkedIn that is related to the original post. You can also share the post of any other LinkedIn member on your profile. Ensure that you add a short write-up about the post before sharing it. Such a practice gives you immediate attention from the creator of the post and their other followers.

Direct messaging is one of the key tools to network with your connections. Remain in touch with your important clients and connections through this feature. You can pitch a product or a service through a message on LinkedIn. It is advisable to give a brief introduction of yourself and your organisation before making a sales pitch to a new connection.

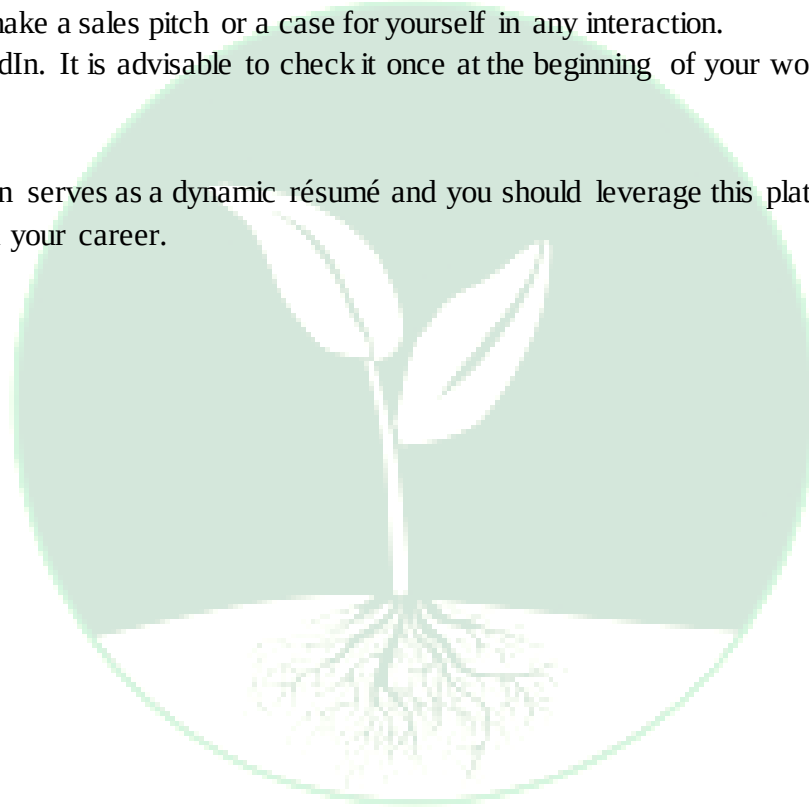
Etiquette and ethics of networking on LinkedIn

- Remember that LinkedIn is a professional network so always keep your comments and messages professional in nature.
- Adhere to the principle of working hours to communicate, even with those who are in different time-zones. You can find a window of common time or interact at respective working hours.
- The use of contact and other information shared on LinkedIn should always be for professional purposes.
- The participation in groups should always be contributory in nature and not predatory.
- Do not share falsehood on LinkedIn to garner attention. It will destroy your reputation.

A list of few do's and don'ts on LinkedIn is as follows.

- Use formal language which is not overtly sterile or distancing, but formal and friendly in nature. Do not use slangs, emoticons, contractions of words, abbreviations, and acronyms in your text on LinkedIn.
- Extend polite curtseys of communication at the beginning of an interaction.
- Respect the boundaries set-up by the other person to create a good will for yourself.
- Keep your profile updated and fresh. It is advisable to review and revise it after every six months.
- Do not be in a rush to make a sales pitch or a case for yourself in any interaction.
- Remain active on LinkedIn. It is advisable to check it once at the beginning of your work day.

Your profile on LinkedIn serves as a dynamic résumé and you should leverage this platform to create opportunities to grow in your career.



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